

EXPERIMENT 1

Form Creation in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To create a simple hostel complaint form using the Zoho Creator platform for collecting and managing student complaints, and to understand how different fields and input components can be used to design a functional form.

2. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform used to build customized applications with minimal programming. Its visual form builder allows fields to be added, configured, and arranged to collect structured information. Submitted complaint data can then be stored and managed within the application.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand the basic process of creating a complaint form using Zoho Creator.
- To learn how to add and configure different fields in a form.
- To understand how a form can collect and store hostel complaint details.
- To configure mandatory fields and simple validation settings.
- To create and preview a functional hostel complaint form.

4. Procedure

1. Log in to the Zoho Creator platform.
2. Create or open the required hostel management application.
3. Create a new form using the Form Builder.
4. Add fields such as Student Name, Register Number, Room Number, Hostel Block, Complaint Type, Complaint Description, Complaint Date, Priority, Contact Number, and Complaint Status.
5. Select suitable field types such as Name, Number, Dropdown, Multi Line, Date, Radio, and Phone.
6. Mark essential fields as mandatory and configure their properties.
7. Arrange the fields in a clear and logical order.
8. Save and preview the form to verify the layout and input fields.
9. Enter sample complaint information and verify that the data can be submitted and stored.

5. Illustrative Example

A Hostel Complaint Management System can use a complaint form to collect student complaints in an organized manner. The form allows students to provide room details, describe the issue, select its priority, and track the complaint status.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

- Student Name – Name field for entering the student's first and last name.
- Register Number – Number field for entering the student's register number.
- Room Number – Number field for recording the student's hostel room.
- Hostel Block – Dropdown field for selecting the hostel block.
- Complaint Type – Dropdown field for selecting the type of complaint.
- Complaint Description – Multi Line field for describing the issue.
- Complaint Date – Date field for recording when the complaint was raised.
- Priority – Radio field for selecting Low, Medium, High, or Urgent.
- Contact Number – Phone field for contact information.
- Complaint Status – Dropdown field for tracking the current status.

5.2 Form Design

The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator Form Builder interface for a 'Hostel Management System' with a 'Hostel Complaints' form. The interface is divided into three main sections: a left sidebar for field selection, a central form canvas, and a right sidebar for field properties.

Left Sidebar (Basic Fields): Contains icons for various field types: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Dropdown, Radio, Checkbox, Currency, and File Upload.

Central Form Canvas: Shows the layout of the complaint form with the following fields:

- Student Name (Name field, marked with a red asterisk)
- 123 Register Number (Number field, marked with a red asterisk)
- 123 Room Number (Number field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Hostel Block (Dropdown field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Complaint Type (Dropdown field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Complaint Description (Multi Line field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Complaint Date (Date field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Priority (Radio field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Contact Number (Phone field, marked with a red asterisk)
- Complaint Status (Dropdown field, marked with a red asterisk)

Right Sidebar (Field Properties): Configures the selected 'Student Name' field.

- Field name:** Student Name
- Field link name:** Student_Name
- Validation:** Mandatory (checked)
- Display Fields:** Prefix (checked), First Name (checked), Last Name (checked), Suffix (checked)
- Data Privacy:** Contains personal data (unchecked)

The bottom of the interface features a navigation bar with 'Form Builder', 'Workflow', 'Actions', and 'Reports' tabs, along with 'Help' and 'Clone Form' links.

Figure 1: Zoho Creator Form Builder showing the Hostel Complaint form.

5.3 Form Preview

The image shows a screenshot of the Zoho Creator interface for a 'Hostel Complaint Management' form. The form is titled 'Hostel Complaints' and is in preview mode. The form fields include:

- Student Name ***: Split into 'First Name' and 'Last Name' text boxes.
- 123 Register Number ***: A text box.
- 123 Room Number ***: A text box.
- Hostel Block ***: A dropdown menu with 'Select' as the placeholder.
- Complaint Type ***: A dropdown menu with 'Select' as the placeholder.
- Complaint Description ***: A multi-line text area.
- Complaint Date ***: A date picker with the format 'dd-MMM-yyyy'.
- Priority ***: Radio buttons for 'Low', 'Medium', 'High', and 'Urgent'.
- Contact Number ***: A text box.
- Complaint Status ***: A dropdown menu with 'Select' as the placeholder.

On the left, there is a 'Basic Fields' sidebar with icons for Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Checkbox, Lookup, and File Upload. On the right, there is a 'Field Properties' sidebar for the 'Student Name' field, showing options for Field name, Field link name, Validation (Mandatory), Display Fields (Prefix, First Name, Last Name, Suffix), and Data Privacy (Contains personal data).

Figure 2: Zoho Creator preview of the Hostel Complaint form.

6. Advantages and Limitations

Advantages

- Simple and visual form-building process.
- Helps organize hostel complaints systematically.
- Different field types can be configured without extensive coding.
- Mandatory fields and basic validation can be applied easily.

Limitations

- Advanced customization may require Deluge scripting.
- Application design depends on the features available on the platform.

7. Result

Thus, a simple Hostel Complaint Management form was successfully designed and previewed in Zoho Creator. The experiment provided an understanding of how different field types and form settings can be used to collect and organize hostel complaints with reduced coding effort.